05-10

started to cut, the matron, who had been watching me and had a look as cold as ice, motioned for him to come over to where she was standing. She whispered something into his ear that caused the barber to shake his head, like he was telling her, "No." In response, the matron walked over to a little man sitting in an office

05-11

chair that squeaked as it rolled around the floor and spoke to him. It was the little man who then walked over and said something to the man who was cutting my hair. The next thing I knew, the man who was cutting my hair told me that he was no longer allowed to give me an Elvis cut. "Why not?" I cried

05-12

desperately. The kindly barber, stopped by the matron, did not answer, but from his expression, I could tell that he wished he could cut it as I had asked. Within a few minutes, it wasn't an Elvis haircut, but a short buzz cut that the barber had given me. When he finished shaving off all

05-13

my hair and made me smell real good with his powder, the barber handed me a nickel and told me to go outside to the snack machine and buy myself a candy bar. I handed him the nickel back and told him that I was not hungry. "I'm so sorry, baby," he said as I climbed out of his barber chair.

05-14

"I am not a baby," I said, as I wiped the tears from my eyes. I then sat down on the floor and brushed away the hair that had accumulated on my shiny new Buster Brown shoes. My head was no longer in the clouds, and I got up off the floor, brushed off my short pants, and walked

05-15

sullenly towards the door. The matron was smiling at me sort of funny-like. The barber, upset by the matron, said to her, "You are just a damn bitch, lady." She yelled back at him at the top of her lungs, before walking toward the office, as fast as she could. To show his anger, the man hit the wall with

05-16

his hand and then walked outside where he stood against the brick wall, smoking a cigarette. I understood right there my haircut was something that had been out of the power of the barber, and then I slowly walked outside to join the man. He looked down, smiled at me, and then he patted me on the top of my bald as a coot head. It

05-17

was a fact of my life that I was not gonna have hair that was anything like Elvis's anytime soon. I then looked up at the barber with my wet red eyes and asked, "Do you know if Elvis Presley has green bones?"

06-01

This is a story of how Mr. Sticky got in Abby's fish tank. "He's very small," Abby's Mom said as she peered at the tiny water snail. Abby said that he would grow and then pulled her pajama bottoms up again before she got into bed, for they were always falling down. Usually, Abby's Mom got up at the crack of

06-02

dawn, but it was Abby who jumped out of bed first the next morning and switched on the light in her fish tank, which contained three fish. At first, she could see neither hide nor hair of the snail, but then she spotted him. It had taken Abby a while to find Sticky because he was clinging to the glass near the bottom, right next to the

04-18

he sings out, "I am king! I am king!" And the other birds in mockery call out, "Yes, yes, the hedge-king! the hedge-king!"

05-01

At ten years old I could not figure out what it was that this Elvis Presley guy had that the rest of us boys did not have. He seemed to be no different from the rest of us. He was simply a man who had a head, two arms, and two legs. It must have been something pretty superlative that he had hidden away because he had every

05-02

young girl at the orphanage wrapped around his little finger. At about nine o'clock on Saturday morning, I figured a good solution was to ask Eugene Correthers, who was one of the older and smarter boys, what it was that made this Elvis guy so special. He told me that it was not anything about Elvis's

05-03

personality, but his wavy hair, and the way he moved his body. About a half-an-hour later, the boys in the orphanage called down to the main dining room by the matron, were told that they were all going to downtown Jacksonville, Florida to get a new pair of

05-04

Buster Brown shoes and a hair cut. That is when I got this big idea, which hit me like a ton of bricks. If the Elvis haircut was the big secret, then Elvis's haircut I was going to get. I was going to have my day in the sun, and all the way to town, that was all I talked about. The fact that I was getting an

05-05

Elvis haircut, not just the simple fact that we were getting out of the orphanage, made me particularly loquacious. I told everybody, including the orphanage matron I normally feared, that I was going to look just like Elvis Presley and that I would learn to move around just like he did and that I would be rich and famous one

05-06

day, just like him. The matron understood my idea was something that I was really excited about and said nothing. When I got my new Buster Brown shoes, I was smiling from ear to ear. Those shoes, they shined really brightly, and I liked looking at the bones in my feet, which I had never seen before, through a

05-07

special x-ray machine they had in the shoe store that made the bones in your feet look green. I was now almost ready to go back to the orphanage and practice being like the man who all the girls loved, since I had my new Buster Brown shoes. It was the new haircut, though, that I needed to complete my new look.

05-08

We finally arrived at the unassuming, unembellished barbershop, where they cut our hair for free because we were orphans. Even though we were supposed to slowly wait to be called, I ran straight up to one of the barber chairs and climbed up onto the board the barber placed across the arms to make me sit up higher.

05-09

I looked at the man and said, with a beaming smile on my face, "I want an Elvis haircut. Can you make my hair like Elvis's?" I asked. The barber, who was a genial young man, grinned back at me and said that he would try his best. I was so happy when he started to cut my hair, but just as he

04-08

ace up his sleeve and he laughed to himself at how easy it had been to outwit the other birds. Higher and higher he mounted until he was lost to sight, and then folding his wings together, he sank to earth crying shrilly, "I am king! I am king!" The eagle, tricked by the little bird, had not sensed the

04-09

bird in his feathers, and so had not at all expected the bird to come flying out like that. The birds back on earth were all up in arms. "You, and not the eagle, our king!?" the birds cried, fuming with anger, "You have done this by breaking every rule in the book, so we will not have you, who are simply tricky and cunning, to reign

04-10

over us." The bird without a name then decided to clear the air and said, "Then let everyone start with a clean slate and perform a new challenging task. Then we can decide who should be the real king." Then the birds gathered together again and decided the case would be resolved by making a new

04-11

condition, which was that he should be king who could go the deepest into the earth. So the little bird, who the other birds despised, was now back to square one. Confident, he remained, however, that if he played his cards right, he could be king. How the goose wallowed in the sand, and the duck strove to dig a hole for the new task!

04-12

All the other birds tried to hide themselves in the ground, too, until they were practically blue in the face. The nameless little bird that was as bold as brass found a pitch dark mouse's hole, and creeping in cried, "I am king! I am king!" but it was of no avail. "You, our king!?" all the

04-13

remaining birds, who the littlest bird had outwitted, cried again even more angrily than before, "Do you think we would reward your cunning in this way? No, no! You shall stay in the earth till you die of hunger!" So they shut up the little bird in the mouse's hole, that the mouse gave up most unwillingly, and bade the owl

04-14

watch him carefully night and day. Then all the birds went home to bed, for they were very tired, but the owl assigned by the birds to stand guard found his job was lonely and wearisome because he was just sitting alone staring at the mouse's hole. "I can close one eye and watch with the other," he thought.

04-15

So he closed one eye and stared steadfastly with the other, but before he knew it he forgot to keep that one open, and both eyes were fast asleep. Then the little bird guarded by the owl peeped out, and when he saw the owl's two eyes tight shut, he slipped from the hole and flew away. He wanted to shout, "I

04-16

am king!" so that the owl could hear him as he flew, but thought better of it. From this time on, the owl, fooled by the little bird, has not dared to show himself by day for fear the birds should beat the living daylights out of him. He flies about only at night-time, hating and pursuing not the bird, but the mouse for having

04-17

made the hole into which the little bird crept. And the little bird also keeps out of sight, for he fears that the other birds should punish him for his cunning. The rejection by the other birds was a bitter pill to swallow for the nameless bird the owl had let slip away. He hides in the hedges, and when he thinks himself quite safe,